
Rick Dearborn



Partner, Mindset; former White House Deputy Chief of Staff

For the past thirty years Rick Dearborn has served two U.S. Presidents, six U.S. Senators, a premier think tank and a major trade association on Capitol Hill. Mr. Dearborn has special expertise in the trade, agriculture, defense, energy, healthcare, and telecom sectors.

From January of 2017 until mid-March of 2018, Mr. Dearborn served The President of the United States as his Deputy Chief of Staff. Mr. Dearborn was responsible for the day-to-day operations of ~100 staff in five separate Executive Office of the President (EOP) departments.

Three days after the 2016 election, President-Elect Trump tapped Vice President-elect Mike Pence to serve as Chairman of the Presidential Transition Team and asked Mr. Dearborn to serve as the Executive Director. Daily responsibility included the direction and management of the core components of the Transition Team's 600+ members.

Prior to leading the President's Transition team, Mr. Dearborn had served for twelve years from 2005 until January of 2017 as Chief of Staff to then U.S. Senator Jeff Sessions. He served Senator Sessions for a total of eighteen and a half years having been originally hired as the Senator's Legislative Director in 1997. In 2003, between serving as Senator Sessions' Legislative Director and Chief of Staff, Mr. Dearborn was nominated by President George W. Bush and confirmed by the U.S. Senate to become the Assistant Secretary of Energy for Congressional Affairs, where he worked with the Senate, House and Tribal Governments on the President's Energy agenda.

Prior employment has included working at the National Republican Senatorial Committee for Sens. Rudy Boschwitz and Don Nickles, The Heritage Foundation, where he was Director of Congressional Relations, and lobbying for the American Medical Association. He has served in Senate Leadership Offices as well, for Senators Trent Lott and Bob Kasten on the Senate Republican Conference, and Senator Kay Bailey Hutchison as Executive Director of the Senate Steering Committee.

Mr. Dearborn graduated from the University of Oklahoma in 1988. He and his wife, Gina split their time between homes in Alexandria, VA and Birmingham, AL.

Maya MacGuineas



President, Committee for a Responsible Federal Budget

Maya MacGuineas is the president of the bipartisan Committee for a Responsible Federal Budget. Her areas of expertise include budget, tax, and economic policy. As a leading budget expert and a political independent, she has worked closely with members of both parties and serves as a trusted resource on Capitol Hill. MacGuineas testifies regularly before Congress and has published broadly, including regularly in *The Washington Post*, *The Wall Street Journal*, *The New York Times*, *The Financial Times*, *The Atlantic*, and numerous other outlets. She also appears regularly as a commentator on television.

MacGuineas oversees a number of the Committee's projects including the grassroots coalition *Fix the Debt*; the Committee's Fiscal Institute; and *FixUS*, a project seeking to better understand the root causes of our nation's growing divisions and deteriorating political system, and to work with others to bring attention to these issues and the need to fix them. Her most recent area of focus is on the future of the economy, technology, and capitalism.

Previously, MacGuineas worked at the Brookings Institution and on Wall Street, and in the spring of 2009 she did a stint on *The Washington Post* editorial board, covering economic and fiscal policy. MacGuineas serves on a number of boards and is a native Washingtonian.

Russ Carnahan



**Former Congressman, United States House of Representatives
Chair, Missouri Democratic Party**

Russ Carnahan served as U. S. Representative for St. Louis, Missouri from 2005-2013. During his tenure in national government, he was a recognized leader in sustainable energy and new technology, a champion for transportation investments to create jobs, and an advocate for our veterans.

He was founder and co-chair of the bipartisan Congressional High Performance Building Caucus to promote policies to increase energy efficiency, economic development and green jobs. He was the House sponsor of the Federal Buildings Personnel Training Act of 2010 to save on energy costs for federal buildings. Carnahan has worked to position Missouri as a global leader in clean energy research, innovation and production, particularly in biofuels. Carnahan was Co-Chairman of the Congressional Study Group on Germany. In order to have better opportunities for political parties to find common ground, he Co-chaired the bipartisan Center Isle Caucus.

Carnahan served on the committees of Foreign Affairs; Transportation & Infrastructure; Science & Technology; and Veterans Affairs. He held leadership positions as Senior Whip; Chairman of the Subcommittee on International Organizations; and Presidential Appointee as Congressional Delegate to the United Nations for the 66th General Assembly.

Carnahan is a member of the Council on Foreign Relations and continues international work on multiple projects including service on the Leadership Team for the Joint International Election Observation Mission for Pakistan and Consultant at the Summit for newly elected leaders of the National Assembly and Senate, Republic of Kenya. He is a member of the Board of Directors for the U.S. Association of Former Members of Congress that sponsors international study groups for current and former Members of Congress. Carnahan also volunteers as a Member of the Selection Committee for the Mel Carnahan Public Service Award at the Harry S. Truman School of Public Affairs, University of Missouri.

Carnahan is a graduate of the University of Missouri-Columbia School of Law and the School of Business and Public Administration.

Michael Fitzpatrick



Partner, Brunswick Group

Michael Fitzpatrick is a Partner at Brunswick Group encompassing public affairs and regulatory counseling across many sectors, with a focus on technology and digital policy, as well as crisis management and litigation communications.

Michael joins Brunswick from Google, where he was Director, Global Strategy & Innovation, Global Affairs. Previously, he was Head of Global Regulatory Affairs and led the Regulatory Affairs Center of Excellence at Google. Prior to that, he was Head of Regulatory Advocacy at General Electric where he was a member of the Global Government Affairs and Policy senior leadership team and coordinated GE's advocacy on issues involving energy/environmental, rail, aviation, healthcare, artificial intelligence, additive manufacturing, spectrum, and commercial drone regulation. Michael is also a former partner at Akin Gump.

Michael was the Associate Administrator of OIRA, where he helped lead the Obama Administration's development of regulatory policy and White House review of significant Executive Branch regulatory actions. He also led the Obama Administration's efforts on international regulatory cooperation, heading multiple U.S. delegations on regulatory issues with the E.U., the U.K., Canada, Mexico, Brazil and the OECD. Michael also served as a Senior Advisor to OIRA during the Clinton Administration.

Michael is currently a member of the American Law Institute (ALI) and the Governing Council of the American Bar Association's Administrative Law Section. He is a Fellow at the National Academy of Public Administration (NAPA) and a Senior Fellow at the Administrative Conference of the United States (ACUS). Michael previously served on the Department of Commerce's Industry Trade Advisory Council.

He is an Adjunct Professor at The Washington Campus, and guest lectures at The Brookings Institution, Harvard's Kennedy School, Penn's Biden School of Public Policy, Georgetown University

Law School, American University Law School, George Washington University, University of Connecticut Law School, Wharton School of Business, and the Canadian School of Public Service.

He currently serves on the Board of Directors of The Woolly Mammoth Theater and is past Board Chair of Cultural Tourism DC.

He received his J.D. from Stanford Law School, an M.A. in American History from the University of Virginia and a B.A. from Brown University.

Major Garrett



**Chief Washington Correspondent
CBS News**

Major Garrett was named CBS News' chief Washington correspondent in December 2018. As chief Washington correspondent, Garrett reports on for all CBS News broadcasts and platforms and is an anchor for "America Decides" on CBS News 24/7. Garrett is also the host of "The Takeout," a weekly multi-platform interview show on politics, policy and pop culture available on CBS News 24/7, top radio stations across the country and all podcast platforms. Garrett is also the host of "Agent of Betrayal: The Double Life of Robert Hanssen," a multi-part and incisive podcast investigation into the most damaging spy in FBI history.

From 2012 until 2018, Garrett served as the Network's chief White House correspondent. While covering the White House for CBS News, Garrett reported extensively on presidential actions to confront ISIS, Ebola, nuclear negotiations with Iran and U.S.-European efforts to confront Russia in the standoff over Ukraine. On domestic issues, Garrett reported on the Obama administration's handling of the health care website rollout, numerous policy failures at the Veterans Administration and the president's ongoing efforts in 2014 to address racial strife and criminal justice reform. He has traveled with the president to Asia, Europe, and the Middle East.

In 2015-2016, Garrett spent 16 months on the road covering the Republican presidential campaign, including every GOP debate, both major party conventions and every day of the general election. During the transition, Garrett broke numerous cabinet appointments, including Jeff Sessions as attorney general. Garrett has covered every major domestic and foreign policy story of the Trump administration.

Before joining CBS News as chief White House correspondent, Garrett was a fixture during CBS News' coverage of Campaign 2012 through a partnership with the National Journal, where he was chief White House correspondent. Prior to National Journal, Garrett was the Chief White House correspondent for Fox News. During his eight years at Fox, Garrett also covered two presidential elections, Congress, the war in Iraq, and other major stories.

Garrett is the author of four books: "Common Cents," with former Rep. Tim Penny (D-Minnesota) Little, Brown Publisher, 1995; "The 15 Biggest Lies in Politics," St. Martin's 1999; "The Enduring Revolution," Crown Forum 2005 and "Mr. Trump's Wild Ride," St. Martin's, 2018.

Jessica L. Ellsworth



Partner

Litigation, Arbitration, and Employment, Hogan Lovells

A Chambers-ranked appellate lawyer, Jess was named Litigator of the Week twice in the past year in connection with Supreme Court wins and Most Innovative Supreme Court Lawyer by the Financial Times. She has handled appeals from motions to dismiss through bench and jury verdicts, and she has led and argued key trial court motions when creating an appellate record is crucial. Her cases range from patent and trademark disputes to class actions, arbitrability, statutory interpretation, and jurisdictional issues. She helps clients from around the world navigate U.S.-based litigation at all levels of courts.

Jess is a leader in administrative law where she regularly pursues and defends against Administrative Procedures Act challenges to government agency action, and she has a niche practice in litigating dispositive motions and appeals in FCA cases. In these, and her other matters, Jess brings her appellate perspective to developing and managing case strategy to achieve her clients' goals.

Whether defending a trial court win or seeking to overcome a trial court loss, Jess crafts winning briefs and persuasively argues cases. Working in our Chambers-ranked Appellate practice, Jess's clients and successful appeals span the technology, automotive, pharmaceutical, health, education, and financial services industries.

Jess clerked for the Honorable Martha Craig Daughtrey (U.S. Court of Appeals for the Sixth Circuit) and the Honorable Rebecca Beach Smith (U.S. District Court for the Eastern District of Virginia). While in law school, Jessica was named Best Oralist by then-U.S. Supreme Court Justice David Souter in the Harvard Law School Ames Moot Court Competition.

Michael O'Hanlon



**Director of Research, Foreign Policy and
Philip H. Knight Chair in Defense and Strategy
The Brookings Institution**

Michael O'Hanlon is the inaugural holder of the Philip H. Knight Chair in Defense and Strategy and director of research in the Foreign Policy program at the Brookings Institution, where he specializes in U.S. defense strategy and budgets, the use of military force, and American national security policy. He is a senior fellow and directs the Strobe Talbott Center on Security, Strategy, and Technology. He co-directs the Africa Security Initiative as well. He is an adjunct professor at Georgetown University and Columbia University and a member of the Pentagon's Defense Policy Board; he was also a member of the external advisory board at the Central Intelligence Agency from 2011-12. In 2023, O'Hanlon published a book titled "Military History for the Modern Strategist: America's Major Wars since 1861." The paperback version of the book, with a preface covering the American Revolution as well as the declared wars of the 19th century, came out in 2024.

O'Hanlon's other books include "The Art of War in an Age of Peace: U.S. Grand Strategy and Resolute Restraint" (Yale, 2021); "Defense 101: Understanding the Military of Today and Tomorrow" (Cornell, 2021); "The Senkaku Paradox: Risking Great Power War over Limited Stakes" (Brookings, 2019); "Beyond NATO: A New Security Architecture for Eastern Europe" (Brookings, 2017); "The Future of Land Warfare" (Brookings, 2015); "Strategic Reassurance and Resolve: U.S.-China Relations in the 21st Century" (with Jim Steinberg, Princeton University Press, 2014); "Crisis on the Korean Peninsula" (with Mike Mochizuki, McGraw-Hill, 2003); "Winning Ugly: NATO's War to Save Kosovo" (with Ivo Daalder, Brookings, 2000); and several other books. His articles have appeared in Foreign Affairs, The National Interest, Survival, Washington Quarterly, Joint Forces Quarterly, and International Security, among other publications; he has also written hundreds of op-eds in major newspapers. Recent articles include a detailed analysis of the U.S. defense budget, a military assessment of a possible Chinese blockade of Taiwan, and a proposal with Georgetown Professor Lise Howard for a new security architecture for eastern Europe. O'Hanlon has appeared on television or spoken on the radio more than 4,000 times since September 11, 2001.

O'Hanlon was an analyst at the Congressional Budget Office from 1989-1994, where he won the Director's Award in 1992. His doctorate from Princeton is in public and international affairs, where he was awarded a National Science Foundation fellowship. His bachelor's and master's degrees, also from Princeton, are in the physical sciences. He served as a Peace Corps volunteer in the Democratic Republic of Congo from 1982-1984, where he taught college and high school physics in French. Earlier, he worked on a dairy farm in Upstate New York, where he grew up. During college, he attempted (unsuccessfully) with a team of Princeton experimental physicists in the "Gravity Group" to disprove Einstein's General Theory of Relativity.

Aaron Klein



**Miriam K. Carliner Chair, Economic Studies
Senior Fellow, Center on Regulation and Markets
The Brookings Institution**

Aaron Klein is Miriam K. Carliner Chair and senior fellow in Economic Studies at the Brookings Institution, focused on financial technology and regulation; payments; macroeconomics; and infrastructure finance and policy. Prior to joining Brookings in 2016, he directed the Bipartisan Policy Center's Financial Regulatory Reform Initiative.

Between 2009 and 2012, Klein served as the deputy assistant secretary for economic policy at the Department of Treasury. He worked on financial regulatory reform issues including crafting and helping secure passage of the Dodd-Frank Wall Street Reform and Consumer Protection Act of 2010. He also played leading roles on responding to the economic crisis, housing finance reform, transportation and infrastructure policy, and Native American policy.

Previously, Klein served as chief economist of the Senate Banking, Housing and Urban Affairs Committee for Chairmen Chris Dodd and Paul Sarbanes. He worked on numerous pieces of major legislation, including the Emergency Economic Stabilization Act (aka TARP), Housing and Economic Recovery Act, and the SAFETEA Act of 2005—re-writing America's surface transportation system.

Klein serves as an external economist and consultant for the National Homebuyers Fund, provides occasional expert analysis for several groups, including Gerson Lerhman Group, AlphaSights, and Guidepoint, and is an expert witness. In prior years he served similar roles for the Native American Finance Officers Association and co-edited the Thompson-Reuters FinTech Law Review.

Klein is a graduate of Dartmouth College and the Princeton School of Public and International Affairs.

Douglas Holtz-Eakin



**President
American Action Forum**

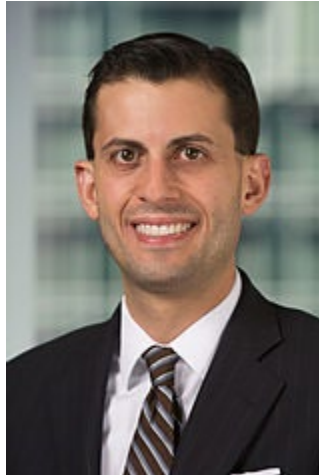
Before founding AAF in 2009, Dr. Holtz-Eakin served in a variety of influential policy positions. During 2001-2002, he was the Chief Economist of the President's Council of Economic Advisers (CEA), where he had also served during 1989-1990 as a Senior Staff Economist. At CEA he helped to formulate policies addressing the 2000-2001 recession and the aftermath of the terrorist attacks of September 11, 2001. From 2003-2005 he was the 6th Director of the non-partisan Congressional Budget Office (CBO), which provides budgetary and policy analysis to the U.S. Congress. During his tenure, CBO assisted Congress as they addressed numerous policies — notably the 2003 tax cuts (the Jobs and Growth Tax Relief Reconciliation Act), the 2003 Medicare prescription drug bill (the Medicare Modernization Act), and the 2005 push for Social Security reform.

During 2007 and 2008, he was Director of Domestic and Economic Policy for the John McCain presidential campaign. After that, he was a Commissioner on the congressionally chartered Financial Crisis Inquiry Commission.

Dr. Holtz-Eakin built an international reputation as a scholar. He began his career at Columbia University in 1985 and moved to Syracuse University from 1990 to 2001. At Syracuse, he became Trustee Professor of Economics at the Maxwell School, Chairman of the Department of Economics and Associate Director of the Center for Policy Research.

Dr. Holtz-Eakin writes a daily column in AAF's morning newsletter, the Daily Dish, and regularly comments on current policy and political debates for a variety of news outlets.

Alex Nowrasteh



**Vice President for Economic and Social Policy Studies
CATO Institute**

Alex Nowrasteh is the vice president for economic and social policy studies. His popular publications have appeared in the Wall Street Journal, USA Today, the Washington Post, and most other major publications in the United States. Nowrasteh regularly appears on Fox News, MSNBC, Bloomberg, NPR, and numerous television and radio stations.

His peer-reviewed academic publications have appeared in the World Bank Economic Review, the Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization, Public Choice, Kyklos, the Journal of Bioeconomics, and others. He has also contributed numerous book chapters to various edited volumes. Nowrasteh is the coauthor (with Benjamin Powell) of *Wretched Refuse? The Political Economy of Immigration and Institutions* (Cambridge University Press, 2020), which is the first book on how economic institutions in receiving countries adjust to immigration. *Wretched Refuse?* received the SDAE Prize for the Best Book in Austrian Economics in 2022 from the Society for the Development of Austrian Economics.

Nowrasteh, a native of Southern California, received a BA in economics from George Mason University and an MS in economic history from the London School of Economics.

Robert Daly



Director, Kissinger Institute on China and The United States Woodrow Wilson International Center for Scholars

Robert Daly was named as the second Director of the Kissinger Institute on China and the United States at the Woodrow Wilson Center in August 2013. He came to the Wilson Center from the Maryland China Initiative at the University of Maryland. Prior to that, he was American Director of the Johns Hopkins University-Nanjing University Center for Chinese and American Studies in Nanjing. Robert Daly began work in U.S.-China relations as a diplomat, serving as Cultural Exchanges Officer at the U.S. Embassy in Beijing in the late 80s and early 90s.

After leaving the Foreign Service, he taught Chinese at Cornell University, worked on television (北京人在纽约) and theater projects in China as a host, actor, and writer, and helped produce Chinese-language versions of Sesame Street and other Children's Television Workshop programs. During the same period, he directed the Syracuse University China Seminar and served as a commentator on Chinese affairs for CNN, the Voice of America, and Chinese television and radio stations. From 2000 to 2001, he was American Director of the U.S.-China Housing Initiative at the Department of Housing and Urban Development. Mr. Daly has testified before Congress on U.S.-China relations and has lectured at scores of Chinese and American institutions, including the Smithsonian Institution, the East-West Center, the Asia Society, and the National Committee on U.S.-China Relations.

He has lived in China for 11 years and has interpreted for Chinese leaders, including Jiang Zemin and Li Yuanchao, and American leaders, including Jimmy Carter and Henry Kissinger.

Ambassador Arturo Sarukhan



Former Mexican Ambassador to the United States

Ambassador Arturo Sarukhan is the founder and president of Sarukhan + Associates. A consultant and public speaker, he is also an adjunct lecturer at the Johns Hopkins School of Advanced International Studies (SAIS), a distinguished visiting professor at the Annenberg School of Public Diplomacy at the University of Southern California, an Associate Fellow at The Royal Institute of International Affairs (Chatham House) in the UK, and a Global Fellow at the Woodrow Wilson Center's Mexico Institute. He writes a biweekly column in Mexico City's *El Financiero* newspaper and frequently publishes op-eds in U.S. media outlets. He also participates in a weekly Mexican television newscast on Milenio TV and a weekly radio segment on Enfoque Noticias.

Ambassador Sarukhan served as a career diplomat in the Mexican Foreign Service for 22 years, receiving the rank of career ambassador in 2006. From 2007 to 2013, he served as Mexico's ambassador to the United States. He was the youngest and longest-serving Mexican ambassador in Washington in modern times and led a team of 250 diplomats, plus an additional staff of 1,500 in Mexico's 50 consulates across the U.S. He became the dean of the Group of Latin American Ambassadors (GRULA) to the United States during his tenure. Ambassador Sarukhan is a digital diplomacy pioneer and the first ambassador accredited in Washington, D.C. to use Twitter in an official capacity as a public diplomacy and outreach and engagement tool.

The grandson and son of Armenian and Catalan conflict refugees in Mexico, Ambassador Sarukhan lived in the United Kingdom as a child and experienced a multicultural, multilingual upbringing and early education.

He read history at the National Autonomous University of Mexico (UNAM) and has a Bachelor Degree in International Relations from El Colegio de Mexico. He earned a Master Degree in American Foreign Policy at the Johns Hopkins School of Advanced International Studies (SAIS), where he was a Fulbright scholar and Ford Foundation fellow.

Ambassador Sarukhan lives in Washington, D.C. He is married and has two young daughters. In his spare time, he is a music aficionado and a rabid soccer player and fan.

Jeffrey Holmstead



Partner, Bracewell LLP

Jeff Holmstead, former assistant administrator of the United States Environmental Protection Agency for Air and Radiation, is one of the nation's leading climate change lawyers as recognized by Chambers USA (2008-2023) and heads the Environmental Strategies Group at Bracewell. The Environmental Strategies Group is a multi-disciplinary group that includes environmental and energy attorneys, public policy advocates and strategic communications experts – most of whom have had high-level government experience. Under Jeff's leadership, they work together on a daily basis to advise and defend companies and business groups confronting major environmental and energy-development challenges, both domestically and globally.

From his time in both the government and the private sector, Jeff is very familiar with the environmental and energy challenges facing the business community. He advises clients dealing with an increasingly complex regulatory, legal and public relations landscape, drawing on his experience in policy development, administrative and legislative advocacy, litigation and strategic communications. He has worked with clients in a number of industries on issues related to climate change, Clean Air Act policy and enforcement, and energy policy – including the development of new coal-fired power plants, refineries, renewable energy sources, and electric transmission infrastructure.

Jeff headed the EPA's Office of Air and Radiation from 2001 to 2005, longer than anyone in EPA history. During his tenure, he was the architect of several of the agency's most important initiatives, including the Clean Air Interstate Rule, the Clean Air Diesel Rule, the Mercury Rule for power plants and the reform of the New Source Review program. He also oversaw the development of the Bush Administration's Clear Skies Legislation and key parts of its Global Climate Change Initiative. Between 1989 and 1993, Jeff served on the White House Staff as Associate Counsel to former President George H.W. Bush. In that capacity, he was involved in the passage of the Clean Air Act Amendments of 1990 and the key steps taken to implement those amendments. From 1987 to 1988, he served as a law clerk to Judge Douglas H. Ginsburg on the U.S. Court of Appeals for the District of Columbia.

Molly Kinder



**Fellow, Brookings Metro
The Brookings Institution**

Molly Kinder is a nationally recognized expert in labor policy, economic inequality, low-wage work, and the present and future of work. Her research at Brookings examines the impact of generative AI on work and workers.

Kinder's scholarship on workers has been covered widely by national media, and she has appeared regularly on NPR and other media outlets. Her work has been cited in The New York Times, The Washington Post, Time, NBC, ABC, CBS, CNN, Yahoo Finance, CNBC, NPR, Business Insider, The Boston Globe, Los Angeles Times, and the BBC. Kinder's research on essential workers has influenced federal policy and state-level programs, and was cited in dozens of city and county government mandates requiring higher pay for frontline workers.

Previously, Kinder was a nonresident senior fellow at New America and directed research for its Work, Workers, and Technology initiative. She is the lead author of a report exploring the perspectives of workers across the country whose jobs are at high risk of automation. Kinder was also a professor of practice at Georgetown University, where she taught a new graduate-level course on the social, economic, and policy implications of AI.

Kinder has over 20 years of experience in public policy, social innovation, research, philanthropy, and teaching. Previously, she co-founded a \$200 million social impact fund and was its vice president of policy; served in the Obama administration as a director in a new innovation program; and co-authored one of the Center for Global Development's best-selling books. Kinder worked overseas in Liberia, India, and Pakistan with the World Bank and government of Liberia. She has an MPA/ID from Harvard's Kennedy School and a B.A. from the University of Notre Dame.